14. Andrei Lankov, *The Real North Korea: Life and Politics in the Failed Stalinist Utopia* (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2013).
15. Graeber and Wengrow, *Dawn of Everything*, chaps 2–5.
16. Ibid., chaps 3–5; Bellah, *Religion in Human Evolution*, 117–209; Pierre Clastres, *Society Against the State: Essays in Political Anthropology* (New York: Zone Books, 1988).
17. Michael L. Ross, *The Oil Curse: How Petroleum Wealth Shapes the Development of Nations* (Princeton, N.J.: Princeton University Press, 2013); Leif Wenar, *Blood Oil: Tyrants, Violence, and the Rules That Run the World* (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2015); Karen Dawisha, *Putin's Kleptocracy: Who Owns Russia?* (New York: Simon & Schuster, 2014).
18. Graeber and Wengrow, *Dawn of Everything*, chaps 3–5; Eric Alden Smith and Brian F. Codding, 'Ecological Variation and Institutionalized Inequality in Hunter-Gatherer Societies', *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences* 118, no. 13 (2021).
19. James Woodburn, 'Egalitarian Societies', *Man* 17, no. 3 (1982): 431–51.
20. Graeber and Wengrow, *Dawn of Everything*, chaps 3–5; Bellah, *Religion in Human Evolution*, chaps 3–5. For a discussion of information flows among the Kope – a tribe in Papua New Guinea of about five thousand people subsisting in part by hunting and foraging and in part by farming—see Madden, Bryson and Palimi, 'Information Behavior in Pre-literate Societies'.
21. For the claim that Mesopotamian city-states like Uruk were occasionally democratic, see Graeber and Wengrow, *Dawn of Everything*.
22. John Thorley, *Athenian Democracy* (London: Routledge, 2005), 74; Nancy Evans, *Civic Rites: Democracy and Religion in Ancient Athens* (Berkeley: University of California Press, 2010), 16.
23. Thorley, *Athenian Democracy;* Evans, *Civic Rites*, 79.